PCV chemotherapy · 42-day cycle

NCCP 00379 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.

STEP 1

Taking the treatment

Lomustine is taken once on Day 1 only; procarbazine is taken daily on Days 8–21; vincristine is given into a vein on Days 8 and 29. Follow the pharmacy label for capsule number, food and timing. Do not open or crush capsules. Lomustine is not a daily medicine. Vincristine must only be given intravenously by trained staff.

STEP 2

Missed or vomited medicine

If a capsule dose is missed or vomited, contact the oncology pharmacy for advice. Do not take extra capsules, repeat the single lomustine dose, or extend procarbazine days without instructions.

STEP 3

Medicine and supplement review

Bring an up-to-date list of all medicines, including steroids, seizure medicines, anticoagulants, non-prescription treatments, vitamins and herbs. Ask before starting something new. Keep a record of all dose changes.

STEP 4

Procarbazine interactions

Avoid alcohol during treatment. Ask for a written food list and medicine interaction check, including the period after procarbazine when precautions still apply. Do not assume an over-the-counter cold remedy, antidepressant, pain medicine or herbal product is safe without pharmacy review.

STEP 5

Storage and handling

Keep capsules in their original labelled packs, away from children. Do not open, crush or chew. If swallowing or medicine organisation is difficult, contact the team before the next dose and agree safe help. Return unused chemotherapy to the pharmacy.

STEP 6

Pregnancy, breastfeeding and fertility

Treatment can harm a pregnancy and may affect fertility. Discuss fertility preservation, contraception for patients and partners, and the required period after the final dose before starting. Do not breastfeed during treatment. Ask the team for written, medicine-specific advice.

STEP 7

Appointments and transport

Before starting: full blood count, kidney and liver tests, glucose and baseline lung-function assessment. NCCP requires blood count, kidney and liver tests before each treatment. Low counts can be delayed and cumulative after lomustine, so keep any additional blood tests the team arranges. Repeat lung-function assessment during prolonged therapy or when clinically indicated. MRI timing follows the individual glioma plan. Current lomustine product information additionally advises weekly blood counts for at least six weeks after each dose; the team should arrange these alongside the NCCP pre-treatment checks.

STEP 8

Help with the daily plan

Ask a trusted person to help check the calendar if memory, vision, fatigue or hand strength makes treatment difficult. Confirm who is responsible for checking doses, collecting medicine, transport and calling for help. Keep consent and personal preferences central.

Sources: NCCP 00379 v4 · current Irish regimen. Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.